METRIC
MIL-PRF-85045/26C
5 November 2021
SUPERSEDING
MIL-PRF-85045/26B
17 June 2014

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION SHEET

CABLE, FIBER OPTIC, SINGLE (ONE) TUBE, BLOWN OPTICAL FIBER, STANDARD AND ENHANCED PERFORMANCE, CABLE CONFIGURATION TYPE 5 (TUBE), APPLICATION B (SHIPBOARD), CABLE CLASS SM AND MM

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-PRF-85045.

CLASSIFICATION:

Fiber optic cable configuration type: 5 (tube)

Fiber optic cable class: MM (graded-index, glass core and glass cladding, multimode)

SM (dispersion-unshifted, glass core and glass cladding, single-mode)

DESIGN AND CONSTRUCTION:

Blown optical fiber tube:

Dimensions and configuration: See figure 1.

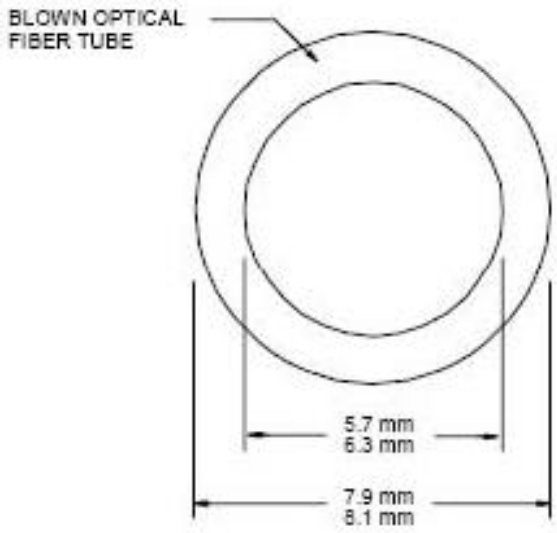


FIGURE 1. Blown optical fiber tube.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release. Distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Short-term minimum bend diameter: 127 millimeters (mm)

Long-term minimum bend diameter: 127 mm

Tensile loading: ≥89 newtons (N)

Tube material: The tube shall be composed of a low-halogen, low-smoke, low-toxicity polymer material.

Finished cable:

Dimensions and configuration: See figure 2. An outer jacket shall be applied over strength members and a central tube. The outer jacket thickness shall be not less than 1.15 mm.

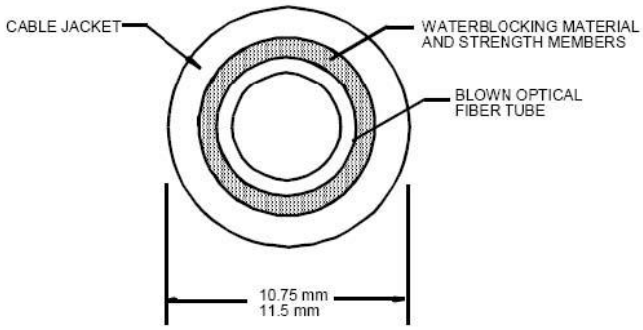


FIGURE 2. Single-tube cable.

Concentricity: ≥0.65

Jacket material: The overall jacket shall be composed of a low-halogen, low-smoke, and low-toxicity polymer material.

Cable jacket color: Shall be black or blue.

Mass per unit length: ≤120 kilograms per kilometer (kg/km)

Short-term minimum bend diameter: 127 mm. (The short-term minimum bend diameter shall be used in all environmental and mechanical tests that specify a cable minimum bend diameter.)

Long-term minimum bend diameter: 127 mm

PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS: The individual performance requirements shall be as specified in MIL-PRF-85045 and this specification sheet, including the requirements identified in table I.

Specimen lengths: Three units, 0.305 km each.

Optical properties:

Change in optical transmittance: Not applicable.

Mechanical properties:

Tensile loading and elongation: Applicable; tensile loading ≥445 N. Change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after the test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Operating tensile loading: Applicable; tensile loading ≥267 N. Change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube during and after the test.

Low temperature flexibility: Applicable, except the change in optical transmittance is not applicable. For standard performance, the exposure temperature shall be the minimum operating temperature. For enhanced performance, the exposure temperature shall be –40 °C. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after the test.

Cyclic flexing: 500 cycles at +25±2 °C and 100 cycles at –28±2 °C. Change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after every 100 cycles for the 500-cycle exposure and every 25 cycles for the 100-cycle exposure. The cycling may be halted to perform the ball bearing test.

Crush: Applicable, except that the load shall be 950 N and the change in optical transmittance and crosstalk are not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after the load is removed.

Radial compression: Applicable, except the change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube during and after the test.

Impact: Applicable, except that the drop hammer mass shall be 1.5 kg. The change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through each tube after the test.

Corner bend: Applicable, except the change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through each tube after the test.

Cable jacket tear strength: Applicable, except the cable jacket tear strength shall be not less than 35 N/centimeter (cm) for standard performance cable.

Tube tensile strength and elongation: Tube specimens shall be tested in accordance with FED-STD-228, Methods 3021 and 3031, with 2.5-cm (0.98-inch) benchmarks, 6.35-cm (2.5-inch) jaw separation, and a rate of travel of 25 cm per minute (9.8 inches per minute). The tensile strength of the tube shall be not less than 900 N/cm^2. The percent elongation-at-break shall be not less than 125 percent. Capstan grips may be used.

Hosing:

Low pressure: Applicable. Tube ends shall be capped with end caps during this test.

Hydrostatic: Not applicable.

Cable scraping resistance: 750 cycles

Cable-to-cable abrasion: 500 cycles

Cable shrinkage: Applicable, except that the total shrinkage shall be not greater than 35 mm.

Pressure withstand: One end of the inner tube shall be capped and a static pressure of 1.4 megapascals (MPa) (200 pounds per square inch [psi]) applied internal to the tube for 10 minutes. After the test, tubes shall show no evidence of splitting, cracking, or rupture. Perform as part of group I on tube in each of the 0.3-km samples.

Environmental properties:

Temperature range:

Operating:	-28 to +65 °C
Nonoperating:	-40 to +70 °C
Storage:	-40 to +70 °C

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Temperature cycling: Change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube at the high temperature plateau, the low temperature plateau, and after the test.

Temperature humidity cycling: Change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube at the high temperature plateau, the low temperature plateau, and after the test.

Storage temperature: Applicable, except the change in optical transmittance is not applicable. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after the test.

Temperature life (life aging): Applicable, except the change in optical transmittance is not applicable and a minimum test sample length of 150 meters (m) may be used. For standard performance products, the test shall be conducted as specified in MIL-PRF-85045. For enhanced performance products, the test shall be conducted as specified in MIL-PRF-85045, except that the jacket material shall be tested at +175 °C for 4 hours. A minimum of 2 m of the sample shall be maintained at the minimum bend diameter throughout the test. A ball bearing with a minimum outer diameter of 4 mm shall pass through the tube after the test.

Off reel testing: Not applicable.

Fluid immersion:

Standard performance: Exposure to automobile gasoline and tap water are not required and the test temperature for lubricating oil exposure shall be 73 to 77 °C. The tensile strength retention of the cable jacket material after exposure to hydraulic fluid shall be not less than 30 percent.

Enhanced performance: Exposure to automobile gasoline and tap water are not required and the following test temperatures shall be used for the fluids indicated: fuel oil (98 to 100 °C), turbine fuel (48 to 50 °C), and lubricating oil (98 to 100 °C).

Flame extinguishing and smoke generation: Applicable. Tube ends shall be plugged with a non-flammable sealant to simulate end caps.

Shock: Applicable. A minimum of three fibers located in the tube shall be monitored during the shock test.

Chemical properties:

Halogen content: <0.2 percent

Cross-link verification: This test is applicable for cables with cross-linked jackets only. The test shall be conducted in accordance with ICEA T-28-562 and run at 200 °C. The test shall be sequenced after the fluid immersion test in the qualification test sequence and in the Group C conformance test sequence. The hot creep shall not exceed 100 percent and the hot creep set shall not exceed 10 percent.

Part or identifying number (PIN):

M85045/26-01S (standard performance)

M85045/26-01E (enhanced performance, cross-linked outer jacket)

Qualification and conformance inspection: See table I. This table specifies applicable requirements, qualification inspections and conformance inspections per this specification sheet. The Requirement Paragraph and Test Paragraph columns within this table reference MIL-PRF-85045. The cable length column of this table applies only to the qualification inspection. A reduced sample set is allowed for conformance inspection; refer to MIL-PRF-85045 for conformance inspection sample size.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and conformance inspection.

Group	Qualification inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Cable length [1/, 2/]	Conformance inspection
I	Visual and mechanical inspection	3.4, 3.9, 3.10	4.7.2	Two samples, 0.3 km each [3/]	A
	Pressure withstand	[4/]	[4/]	Two specimens, 2 m each [3/]	--
II	Temperature cycling	3.7.1	[4/]	Two samples, 0.3 km each [5/] (one on reel, one off)	C
	Temperature humidity cycling	3.7.3	4.7.6.3	Two samples, 0.3 km each [6/]	C
	Storage temperature	3.7.4	4.7.6.4	Two samples, 0.3 km each [6/]	--
	Low temperature flexibility (cold bend)	3.6.3	4.7.5.3	Two specimens, 8 m each [7/]	B
	Cyclic flexing	3.6.4	4.7.5.4	Six specimens, 5 m each [8/] (two specimens at each temperature)	--
	Crush	3.6.5	4.7.5.5	Two specimens, 5 m each [7/]	--
	Impact	3.6.8	4.7.5.8	Two specimens, 5 m each [7/]	C
	Temperature life (life aging)	[4/]	[4/]	Two specimens, 150 m each [7/]	C
	Tensile loading and elongation	3.6.1	4.7.5.1	Two specimens, 150 m each [9/]	C
	Operating tensile loading	3.6.1.1	4.7.5.1.1	Two specimens, 150 m each [10/]	C
	Fungus resistance	3.8.4	4.8.4	Two specimens, 0.5 m each [7/]	--
	Cable element removability	3.6.18	4.7.5.18	Two specimens, 0.5 m each [7/]	C
III	Fluid immersion	3.7.9	4.7.6.9	One specimen, 2 m [11/] and three material samples [12/] for each specified fluid	C
	Paint susceptibility	3.7.15	4.7.6.15	Two specimens, 2 m each [13/]	--
	Jacket self-adhesion or blocking	3.7.11	4.7.6.11	One specimen, 30 m [11/]	--
	Shock	3.7.13	4.7.6.13	One specimen, 30 m [11/]	--
	Tube tensile strength and elongation	[4/]	[4/]	One specimen, 1 m	--
	Hosing: low pressure	3.6.12.1	4.7.5.12.1	One specimen, 1.5 m [11/]	C
	Radial compression (for application B only)	3.6.7	4.7.5.7	One specimen, 10 m [11/]	--
	Corner bend	3.6.9	4.7.5.9	Two specimens, 5 m each [13/]	--
	Cross-link verification	[4/]	[4/]	Two specimens, 1 m each [11/]	C

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Qualification and conformance inspection – Continued.

Group	Qualification inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Cable length [1/, 2/]	Conformance inspection
IV	Dripping	3.6.13	4.7.5.13	One specimen, 30 cm [11/]	--
	Cable jacket tear strength	3.6.14	4.7.5.14	Five flat extruded jacket material strips [14/]	C
	Cable jacket material tensile strength and elongation	3.6.15	4.7.5.15	Five specimens [15/]	--
	Cable abrasion resistance	3.6.16	4.7.5.16	Four specimens, 2 m each [16/]	C
	Cable shrinkage	3.6.17	4.7.5.17	Three specimens, 0.5 m each [13/]	C
	Durability of identification	3.6.19	4.7.5.19	Three specimens, 2 m each [13/]	--
	Flame extinguishing and smoke generation	3.7.12.2	4.7.6.12.2	One specimen, 50 m [11/]	C
	Water absorption	3.7.14	4.7.6.14	Two specimens, extruded jacket material strips [15/]	--
V	Acid gas generation	3.8.1	4.8.1	One specimen, 1 m [17/]	C
	Halogen content	3.8.2	4.8.2	One specimen, 1 m [17/]	--
	Toxicity index	3.8.3	4.8.3	One specimen, 1 m [17/]	C
	Smoke index	3.8.5	4.8.6	One specimen, 1 m [17/]	C

NOTES:

1/ Tolerance on 0.3 km length is ±5 percent.
2/ Tolerance on shorter lengths is ±5 percent.
3/ The inspection shall only be conducted on a 2-m section of each sample.
4/ As stated under the applicable tests in this specification sheet.
5/ The same samples as used in the visual and mechanical inspection shall be used.
6/ The same samples as used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.
7/ A specimen cut from each sample used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.
8/ Three specimens cut from each sample used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.
9/ A specimen cut from each specimen used in the temperature life test shall be used.
10/ The same specimen as used in the tensile loading and elongation test shall be used.
11/ A specimen cut from the specimen used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.
12/ Three flat extruded jacket material strips as specified in 4.7.5.15 shall be used in this test.
13/ Specimens cut from the specimen used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.
14/ Flat extruded jacket material strips (i.e., strips of flat extruded material with the same composition as the cable jacket and of sufficient dimensions in which dumbbells can be cut) prepared as specified in 4.7.5.14 and obtained from flat extruded material that underwent the temperature cycling test shall be used.
15/ Flat extruded jacket material as specified in 4.7.5.15 shall be used in this test.
16/ Specimen cut from the sample used in the temperature cycling test shall be used. Two specimens shall be used for scraping abrasion and two specimens shall be used in the cable-to-cable abrasion testing.
17/ A specimen cut from one of the samples used in the temperature cycling test shall be used.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Qualification by similarity:

Manufacturers who produce enhanced performance products for both MIL-PRF-85045/25 and this specification sheet, who are qualified under M85045/25-01E, and whose enhanced performance product produced under this specification sheet passes all tests identified in table II, are qualified under this specification sheet for enhanced performance product (M85045/26-01E). This qualification by similarity is applicable if the same cable jacket and other materials are used in the previously qualified M85045/25-01E cable and the enhanced performance cable under test.

Manufacturers who produce standard performance products for both MIL-PRF-85045/25 and this specification sheet, who are qualified under M85045/25-01S, and whose standard performance product produced under this specification sheet passes the visual and mechanical, low temperature flexibility (cold bend), cyclic flexing, crush, impact, temperature life (life aging) (complete cable only), tensile loading and elongation, operating tensile load, low pressure hosing, radial compression, corner bend, cable abrasion resistance, and flame extinguishing and smoke generation inspections specified herein are qualified under this specification sheet for standard performance product (M85045/26-01S). This qualification by similarity is applicable if the same cable jacket and other materials are used in the previously qualified M85045/25-01S cable and the standard performance cable under test.

TABLE II. Qualification and conformance by similarity to M85045/25-01S and M85045/25-01E.

Group	Qualification inspection	M85045/26-01S Qualification inspection 1/	M85045/26-01S Conformance inspection 2/	M85045/26-01E Qualification inspection 3/	M85045/26-01E Conformance inspection 4/
I	Visual and mechanical inspection	X	A	X	A
III	Low temperature flexibility (cold bend)	X	B	X	B
	Cyclic flexing	X	--	X	--
	Crush	X	--	X	--
	Impact	X	C	X	C
	Temperature life (life aging) 5/	X	C	X	C
	Tensile loading and elongation	X	C	X	C
	Operating tensile loading	X	C	X	C
IV	Hosing: low pressure	X	C	X	C
	Radial compression (for application B only)	X	--	X	--
	Corner bend	X	--	X	--
V	Cable abrasion resistance	X	C	X	C
	Flame extinguishing and smoke generation	X	C	X	C

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Qualification and conformance by similarity to M85045/25-01S and M85045/25-01E – Continued.

NOTES:

1/ Where manufacturers are qualified for M85045/25-01S and are pursuing qualification for M85045/26-01S.
2/ Where manufacturers are qualified for M85045/25-01S and M85045/26-01S and are performing conformance testing for M85045/26-01S.
3/ Where manufacturers are qualified for M85045/25-01E and are pursuing qualification for M85045/26-01E.
4/ Where manufacturers are qualified for M85045/25-01E and M85045/26-01E and are performing conformance testing for M85045/26-01E.
5/ Complete cable only.

Qualification by similarity for change to outer cable jacket: Manufacturers who produce products for MIL-PRF-85045/26 using one particular overall cable jacket compound, are qualified under MIL-PRF-85045/26 for that compound, and pass all tests identified in table III the modified overall cable jacket compound or modified cable jacket color are also qualified under MIL-PRF-85045/26 for cables with the modified overall cable jacket compound.

TABLE III. Qualification by similarity for change in cable jacket compound or color.

Group	Qualification inspection	Modified overall cable jacket compound	Modified cable jacket color 1/
I	Visual and mechanical inspection	X	X
III	Low temperature flexibility (cold bend)	X	X
	Cyclic flexing	3/	--
	Temperature life (life aging)	3/	--
	Fungus resistance	4/	4/
IV	Fluid immersion	X	--
	Paint susceptibility	X	--
	Jacket self-adhesion or blocking	X	--
	Hosing: low pressure	2/	2/
	Cross-link verification	X	X
V	Dripping	X	--
	Cable jacket tear strength	3/	--
	Cable jacket material tensile strength and elongation	X	X
	Cable abrasion resistance	X	--
	Cable shrinkage	2/	2/
	Durability of identification	X	X
	Flame extinguishing and smoke generation	X	X
	Water absorption	X	X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Qualification by similarity for change in cable jacket compound or color – Continued.

Group	Qualification inspection	Modified overall cable jacket compound	Modified cable jacket color 1/
VI	Acid gas generation	X	X
	Halogen content	X 5/	X 5/
	Toxicity index	X	X
	Smoke index	X	X

NOTES:
1/ Perform if only colorants have changed.
2/ Perform if process conditions change.
3/ Perform if results of cable jacket material tensile strength and elongation for the modified cable jacket are not the same as the qualified cable jacket.
4/ Perform unless fungus inert as defined in MIL-HDBK-454.
5/ If information on formulation of colorants is provided, test may be waived.

Qualification by similarity for change to tube: Manufacturers who produce products for MIL-PRF-85045/26 using one particular tube, are qualified under MIL-PRF-85045/26 for that tube, and pass all tests identified in table IV for cables with a modified tube are also qualified under MIL-PRF-85045/26 for cables with the modified tube.

TABLE IV. Qualification by similarity for change in tube.

Group	Qualification inspection	Change to tube
I	Visual and mechanical inspection	X
III	Temperature cycling	X
	Temperature humidity cycling	X
	Storage temperature	X
	Low temperature flexibility (cold bend)	X
	Cyclic flexing	X
	Impact	X
	Temperature life (life aging)	X
	Fungus resistance	X 1/
IV	Radial compression (for application B only)	X
V	Dripping	X
	Cable shrinkage	X
	Flame extinguishing and smoke generation	X
VI	Acid gas generation	X
	Halogen content	X
	Toxicity index	X
	Smoke index	X

NOTES:
1/ Perform unless fungus inert in accordance with MIL-HDBK-454.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Intended use: This cable is intended for use as a local cable and is not intended for installation in the cableways.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army – CR
Navy – SH
Air Force – 85
NASA – NA

Preparing activity:
Navy – SH
(Project 6015-2020-011)

Review activities:
Army – AR, AV, MI
Navy – EC, YD
Air Force – 02, 19
DLA – CC

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T10:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.